

Professional:

1. “[...] I feel like a lot of us have become a little too attached to our work. You know? We identify with our work. Have you asked somebody just randomly like, Hey tell me about yourself? and they will be like, “Well, I’m an architect.” Tell me about yourself? “Well, I own a hair salon.” Tell me about yourself? “Well, I’m a teacher..” Tell me about yourself, and people will tell you about what they do. You know. It’s become the thing that people focus on. The French don’t do that. No. You’ll literally never meet a French person who does it. You’ll go up to a French person, you’ll be like, “Excuse me, what do you do?” and they’ll be like, “Oh, me? I go for walks with my friends. And I like to, you know, eat good food.” And you’ll be like, No, no! What do you do for a living? “- For a living? A pardon, pardon. For a living, okay. I breathe, I drink water, and of course I have to make love, you know.”
- Trevor Noah. [LINK](#)

Mechanism: Frame-shifting because we usually answer similarly like the speaker said, often mentioning our jobs/occupations. However, the speaker shifted the answer to something as simple as taking a breath, which many people found funny.

Contextual: How do you spot a first-year in winter? They’re still shocked their eyelashes freeze on the walk to Baker-Berry!

Mechanism: It draws on *pragmatics*– assuming that everyone experiences the frigid winters at Dartmouth, but freshmen are new to it, so they’re still shocked.

AI-generated joke:

(1) An American author says, “I just wrote a novel about finding happiness.” The Russian writer replies, “Ah, yes, my last novel was about happiness, too—but in chapter one, it dies in a snowstorm.”

Mechanism: This joke uses frame-shifting by contrasting the typically optimistic tone in American literature with the often existential themes of Russian literature. The punchline humorously frames happiness as doomed from the start in the Russian writer’s story, emphasizing the stereotypical themes of melancholy and hardship in Russian novels.

(2) An American writer asks, “How do you keep your readers engaged?” The Russian writer answers, “Simple. By never letting them feel joy.”

Mechanism: This joke uses exaggeration to emphasize the dark, heavy nature of many classic Russian novels, like from Lev Tolstoy. Engagement -> a denial of happiness (role-reversal).

(3) At a writers' conference, an American author says, "My new book is about chasing the American Dream." The Russian writer shrugs and says, "My new book is about running from the Russian Reality."

Mechanism: This joke contrasts the idea of the "American Dream," which embodies hope and opportunity, with the more challenging experiences often depicted in Russian literature. The role reversal here humorously reframes Russia as something to *escape*, while the American Dream represents something to *chase*.